

17 Numbers Every Business Owner Must Track

Most business owners only see their real financial position at tax season. By then it is too late to change anything. These are the numbers that show you the truth in real time, organized by how often to actually check them.

CHECK DAILY

1 Cash on Hand

Checking + Savings + Reserve Accounts (as of this morning)

The single most immediate number in the business. It answers the question "can I actually pay for something today?"

2 Bills Due Today (Accounts Payable Due)

Total bills scheduled to be paid today

Confirms nothing slips through unpaid and helps you plan same day cash needs before they become a problem.

3 Overdue Invoices Owed to You

Total unpaid invoices already past their due date

A quick daily glance catches slow paying clients early, before the balance grows into a real cash flow problem.

4 Prior Day Transaction Review (Fraud Check)

Review yesterday's bank and card transactions line by line for anything unfamiliar

Catching an unauthorized or duplicate charge within a day of it happening is far easier to reverse than catching it weeks later.

CHECK WEEKLY

5 Free Cash Flow This Week

Cash Received This Week - Cash Paid Out This Week

This is the number that actually determines whether payroll clears, not what the profit and loss statement says for the month.

6 Upcoming Bills (Next 7 to 14 Days)

Total bills due in the next 7 to 14 days

Knowing what is coming due before it is due is the difference between planning ahead and scrambling.

7 New Sales Booked This Week

Total value of new deals signed or invoiced this week

Revenue happening today is the leading indicator for your cash position 30 to 60 days from now.

8 Full Aging Report Review (Receivables and Payables)

Outstanding balances sorted into 0 to 30, 31 to 60, 61 to 90, and 90+ day buckets

A full weekly review catches slow payers and looming bills that a quick daily glance can miss.

CHECK MONTHLY

9 Gross Profit Margin

$(\text{Revenue} - \text{Cost of Goods/Services Sold}) \div \text{Revenue} \times 100$

Shows whether what you sell is actually profitable before overhead even enters the picture.

10 Net Profit Margin

$\text{Net Income} \div \text{Revenue} \times 100$

The real "bottom line" percentage. What is actually left after every cost, including taxes.

11 Operating Expense Ratio

$\text{Total Operating Expenses} \div \text{Revenue} \times 100$

Tracks whether overhead is quietly growing faster than revenue, a common way healthy looking businesses become unhealthy.

12 Cash Runway (Burn Rate)

$\text{Cash on Hand} \div \text{Average Monthly Net Cash Burn}$

Tells you, in months, how long the business can operate if income stopped tomorrow. One of the clearest warning numbers for a growing business.

CHECK QUARTERLY

13 Customer Acquisition Cost (CAC)

$$\text{Total Sales \& Marketing Spend} \div \text{Number of New Customers Acquired}$$

Tells you exactly what it costs to earn one new customer, the number that shows whether your marketing is actually working.

14 Customer Lifetime Value to CAC Ratio (LTV:CAC)

$$(\text{Average Customer Value} \times \text{Average Customer Lifespan}) \div \text{CAC}$$

A healthy business generally wants this around 3 to 1 or higher. It shows whether a new customer is actually worth what it costs to get them.

15 Progress Toward Annual Target

$$\text{Year to Date Actual (Revenue or Profit)} \div \text{Year to Date Target} \times 100$$

Shows early, while there is still time to adjust, whether the business is on pace to hit its annual goals or falling behind.

16 Budget vs. Actual Expense Variance

$$(\text{Actual Expenses} - \text{Budgeted Expenses}) \div \text{Budgeted Expenses} \times 100$$

A healthy business generally keeps this within about 10%. Bigger swings mean spending is drifting away from the plan.

17 Accounts Receivable Health Check (90+ Days Past Due)

$$\text{Total value of invoices sitting in the 90+ day past due bucket}$$

This number should sit as close to zero as possible. Anything aging past 90 days has a high chance of never getting collected.

Want someone tracking these for you? Perugi Partners builds structured bookkeeping and monthly financial reporting for growing businesses, so you always know your real numbers, not just your revenue.

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